

Create your first visualization

Activity · Visualizations & Interpretation · ~15 min

BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ You're signed in and looking at your country's project
- ☐ You're in the **Visualizations** tab
- ☐ You have a folder of your own (or you can use the shared one)

What you'll do

Build three time-series charts: first **ANC1**, then **BCG**, then **one indicator of your choice**. Each chart is saved into your folder in the project's Visualizations list. The next activity does the same task with the AI Assistant.

1 Open the Create visualization dialog

In the **Visualizations** tab, click the **+ Create visualization** button in the top right.

A dialog opens that walks you through two steps — **Metric** then **Presets**. Picking a named preset opens the chart in the editor; picking **Custom** adds a third **Configure** step instead.

Create visualization

1 Metric

2 Presets

3 Configure

All modules17

M1. Data quality asse...5

M2. Data quality adjus...3

M3. Service utilization9

M4. Coverage estimat...3

M5. Coverage estimat...6

M6. Coverage estimat...5

Number of services reported, by adjustment type

5 presets

Difference between actual and expected service volume

Select geographic level:

NationalAdmin area 2

Actual vs expected service volume

1 preset

Select geographic level:

NationalAdmin area 2

Cancel

Next

2 Pick a metric

In the left panel of the dialog, click **M3. Service utilization**. The grid on the right now lists only M3 metrics.

Click the tile **Number of services reported, by adjustment type**, then **Next** at the bottom right.

A metric is *what is measured*. A preset is *one ready-made way to draw it*. Each module groups the metrics it produces.

3 Pick a preset

On the **Presets** step, click **Service volume over time (monthly)** — a line chart of monthly volume — then **Create**.

The chart opens in the editor.

4 Filter to ANC1, last 12 months

The chart opens with every indicator drawn across the full date range. You'll narrow it to **ANC1, last 12 months**.

In the chart editor's **left panel**, scroll down to **Filter (subset)** and do two things:

- Tick **Indicator** — a row of chips appears (ANC1, ANC4, BCG, ...). The chips start unselected; click **ANC1** to add it. Only the chips you add show in the chart.
- Tick **Time period** — the default is *Last N months* with N = 12, so the window is already correct. Use the slider if you want a different length.

The chart updates each time you tick.

The metric also exposes four **Data values** chips (`count_final_none` , `_outliers` , `_completeness` , `_both`). The default `count_final_both` means *adjusted for both outliers and completeness* — the cleaner version of your country's data. Leave it as is unless you specifically want a different adjustment.

5 Save it to your folder

Click **Save as new visualization** at the top of the editor. Give it a clear name (e.g. *ANC1 — monthly, last 12 months*) and save it into **your folder**.

It now appears in the Visualizations list under your folder.

Now do it twice more

Repeat the same five steps for:

1. **BCG** — same path, but tick **BCG** at Step 4 instead of ANC1.
2. **An indicator of your choice** — anything that interests you (Pental, ANC4, IPD admissions...).

You should end up with **three saved charts in your folder**.

Filter vs disaggregate — what's the difference?

These two words come up a lot. They are not the same:

- **Filter = pick what to show.** Choose the indicators, places, or months you want — only those appear. e.g. *show ANC1 only*, or *Northern region only*. Like a spotlight: you point it at what you want to see.
- **Disaggregate = break it down.** Split one total into its parts so you can compare them — e.g. *one line per indicator*, or *one bar per district*. Nothing is hidden; the total is shown as its pieces.

FILTER = choose what to show

All indicators are available

☐ ANC1

☐ ANC4

☐ BCG

☐ Penta



You picked ANC1 → only ANC1 shows

☒ ANC1

☐ ANC4

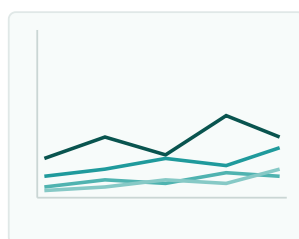
☐ BCG

☐ Penta

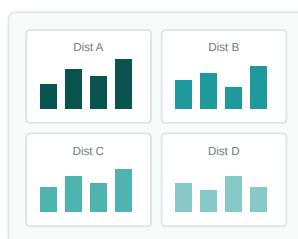
You pick what you want to see.

Whatever you don't tick simply isn't shown — like a spotlight.

DISAGGREGATE “ANC1 by district” — four ways to display the parts



Lines
one line per district



Grid
a mini chart for each

District	Visits
Dist A	900
Dist B	850
Dist C	1,000
Dist D	800

Rows
one row per district

Dist A	Dist B	Dist C	Dist D
900	850	1,000	800

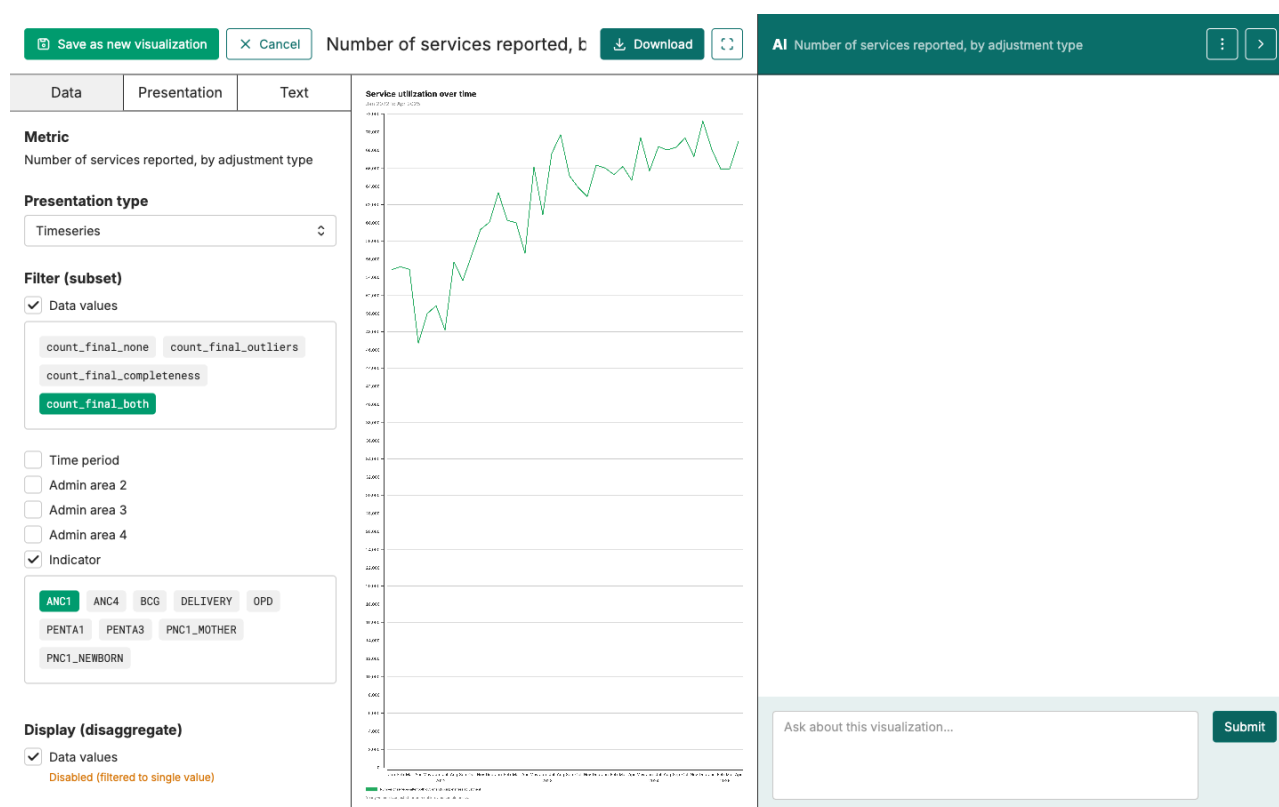
Columns
one column per district

Example. Start with *total ANC1 visits, nationally*. **Filter** to "Northern region" → now you see only Northern's ANC1. **Disaggregate** "by district" → the same total split into one bar (or line) per district.

Where you do this when you edit a viz

Open a saved visualization — the controls live in the **left panel**, and you'll often need to **scroll down** to find them (this is where people get lost). Two sections do the work:

- **Filter (subset)** — **pick what you want to see**: tick **Time period**, **Indicator**, and any admin level. Only the items you select appear.
- **Display (disaggregate)** — choose **how the parts are shown**. The dropdown gives five options:
 - **Lines** — one line per part, all on the same chart
 - **Grid** — a separate little chart for each part, side by side
 - **Rows** — one table row per part
 - **Columns** — one table column per part
 - **Multi-chart (replicants)** — one full-size chart per part, stacked



Watch out when you use both together. Here's the trap, with an example. You split a chart **by district** because you want to compare the districts. Then you **filter** it down to just one district — so the others disappear. Now you're looking at a single district on its own, and there's nothing left to compare.

The simple rule: use **filter** to pick the data you want to look at, and use **disaggregate** to split it into the parts you want to compare. Just don't filter down to only one of the things you wanted to compare.

Exercise: split your ANC1 chart by admin level

Right now your ANC1 chart shows one line: the national total over the last 12 months. You'll turn it into one line per **admin area** so you can compare them side by side.

1 Open the chart

In the **Visualizations** list, open your saved ANC1 chart (the one you named *ANC1 – monthly, last 12 months*).

2 Disaggregate by admin level

In the chart editor's **left panel**, scroll down to **Display (disaggregate)**.

- Tick the admin level you want to compare. In FASTR the levels are labelled generically — **Admin area 2** is typically *Region*, **Admin area 3** is *District*, **Admin area 4** is *Facility*. Pick *Admin area 2* to see one line per region.
- Leave the display style on **Lines** for now — one line per region, all on the same chart.

The chart redraws. Instead of one national line, you should now see **one line per region**.

3 Try the other Display styles

Same data, different shape:

- **Grid** — a separate little chart per region, side by side. Useful when there are many regions and the lines overlap.
- **Rows** — a table with one row per region. Useful when you want the exact values rather than the shape.
- **Columns** — a table with one column per region.
- **Multi-chart (replicants)** — one full-size chart per region, stacked. Useful when each region deserves a full read.

Pick whichever reads best for your data.

4 Save it as a new chart

Click **Save as new visualization** — name it e.g. *ANC1 – monthly, by region* and save it into **your folder**.

Don't overwrite the national chart. Save *as new visualization*, not just *save*, so you keep both: the national trend and the regional split.

Watch out

You set both Filter and Display in step 2 of the original walkthrough (filter to ANC1, last 12 months) and step 2 of this exercise (disaggregate by region). That's fine. The trap is **filtering down to one of the things you said you wanted to compare** — e.g. disaggregate by region *and then* filter to a single region. You'd be left with one line, nothing to compare.

Now do it for BCG

Repeat the same three steps on your saved BCG chart. You should end up with **two regional charts** in your folder: one for ANC1, one for BCG.

Try a few more options

Once your three charts are saved, try a different metric or preset:

- A coverage metric under **M6** (a coverage curve, not a volume trend).
- The quarterly-change bar chart preset (compares periods instead of plotting a continuous trend).

Tip: Line charts (*Service volume over time*) are best for trends over time. Bar charts (*quarterly / annual change*) are better for comparing periods or places. The reference handout *How to read a FASTR visualization* goes deeper.

Check yourself

You should now have:

- **Three saved charts** in your folder: ANC1, BCG, and one of your choice.
- The path memorised: **+ Create visualization** → **M3** → **metric** → **preset** → **filter** → **Save as new visualization**.
- A sense of which presets suit trends vs comparisons.

What's next

The next activity does the same thing using the AI Assistant — typing the request in plain language instead of clicking through the dialog. Same end result, different path.